

Date: Thursday Jan 18, 2018 UTC 1000 – 1130

1. 10:00 – 10:10 - Welcome and Roll Call – Moderator

Role Call 9: Claudio Maccone (CM), Denise Herzing (DH), John Elliot (JE), Michael A Garrett (MAG), Ian Morrison (IM), Martin Dominick (MD), Eric Korpela (EK), Emilio Enriquez (EE) Eric Korpela (EK), Elizabeth Pioteleta (EP).

MAG volunteered to moderate the meeting.

MAG and DH volunteered to make notes of the meeting.

2. 10:10 – 10:20 - Review of Minutes from IAC 2017 and approve:

MAG asked for comments – there were no comments on the minutes. It was unclear whether the minutes could be approved without a larger membership present (see Action Items below).

3. 10:20 – 10:35 -Review of open action items: CM

Action Items from IAC minutes 2017

a. Chair:

- Action Item: DH to organize quarterly SETI PC meetings.

DONE

b. Rio Scale:

- Action Item: DF and JE to get together to consider how Rio 2.0 connects with post-detection activities. **OPEN**

JE reports that the discussion is still being refined, JE will contact DF to reinitiate.

- Action Item: AS to circulate the presentation to PC members.

DONE.

c. FAST:

- Action Item: AS to circulate the presentation to PC members.

OPEN

d. SETI Protocols:

- Action Item: AS to circulate LT's presentation to the membership. **OPEN**
- Action Item: LT and DF to generate a 2018 update of the Protocols to be presented to the SETI PC for approval at their next meeting of the IAC 2018. **OPEN**

e. Millimetron

- Action Item: AS to circulate the presentation to PC members.

OPEN

f. Upcoming SETI related meetings

- Action item: CO will engage with session E1.9 chairs NbH in order to ensure these matters are properly coordinated in future.

OPEN

NEW ACTION ITEM: CM WILL CONTACT NbH AND EXPLORE

g. New Members

- Action item: the PC will review its membership at each meeting. This activity will be scheduled as a standing item on PC agendas (CM). **DONE**

This issue raised the question of what kind of quorum was required in order for the membership to make key decisions (e.g. member appointments). Given the wide variance in meeting attendance (including face-to-face meetings), it was suggested that quorum within the exec was one important aspect to be considered.

NEW ACTION ITEM: CM together with the Exec Committee

will present to the membership a proposal on defining quorum for the PC.

- Action Item: the PC will review the process for appointing and re-appointing members at its next meeting. **OPEN** – IAC

There was some discussion on the process of appointing new members. Some suggestions included... the need for there to be a clear commitment from new members to be active within the PC. A call for new members should be made, and applications should be accompanied with a CV and a short statement from the member. The deadline for new members should be at least 2 weeks before the f2f IAC meeting in September/October.

NEW ACTION ITEM: CM together with the Exec Committee to present to the membership (in Bremen) a process on how new members are appointed.

h. AOB

- Action Item: CM will ensure that the SETI PC agenda is ordered such that items of committee business are placed towards the top of the agenda, ensuring that there is sufficient time to discuss key decisions e.g. membership. **DONE**

3. 10:35 – 10:45 - Report from the Chair – CM

4. 10:45 – 10:55 - Business items – OPEN

New IAC site – need volunteer (s) to handle social media and Engage. Need social media focus... Danny Price and Steve Croft currently handle Breakthrough social media.

ACTION ITEM: EE will talk to colleagues at Breakthrough to see if they could take this on **OPEN**

5. 10:55 – 11:10 - Research/project items – OPEN

Post detection – this is a very important topic - JE called for more action and discussion. Is there still a list on the IAA website? DH will acquire list and circulate the list. MAG noted that the IAA disbanded the WGs a few years ago, and not without reason. We should talk to the IAA President (JMC) if we wish to recreate these. It would be important to identify a truly active chair of any re-instated WGs, and membership should be expanded so that new members are also consulted.

There was discussion on need for funding post-detection, like it has been available for the listening component.

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ACTION ITEM: CM to ensure Post-Detection will appear on the agenda at the IAC 2018 meeting.

ACTION ITEM: CM will arrange for a meeting room to be organized for interested PC members to consider how Post-detection activities can be rejuvenated.

ACTION ITEM: JE will submit an abstract for PDC ideas and plan of action, for the IAC 2018.

ACTION ITEM: JE/DH to explore how to re-energize activity in PD issues, communicating with the larger membership. An active chair of any potential working group should be identified.

ACTION ITEM: CM to organize meeting with Jean-Michelle Contant regarding the creation of new WGs.

Protection of the farside of the Moon was discussed. There is more interest in this topic as the idea of a Moon Village begins to take hold. Many scientists (in particular cosmologists and radio

astronomers) are interested in placing scientific instruments on the Moon. CM and Prof. J. Silk will be make a presentation on this issue at the IAC 2018 in Bremen. MD and CM discussed the status of the 1979 Moon Agreement. This was poorly ratified (US did not sign, in addition to other major space-faring countries. Commercial interests in the US, and in other countries has also increased recently. According to CM, China might be supportive of signing the Moon Agreement if other countries were also interested. MAG reported that China is preparing to launch Chang'e-4 – the Dutch are building a low-frequency radio package for the orbiter, making measurements when the spacecraft is on the farside of the Moon. EE noted that the protection of the radio spectrum was well organized via the ground-based radio observatories, and they may have useful experience to bring to potential discussions.

ACTION ITEM: MAG to put CM in touch with groups such as CRAF

Breakthrough update: EE gave an update. An FRB (Fast Radio Bursts) paper was recently published in Nature and additional publications are being prepared. This work is in collaboraton with an international group of astronomers led from the Netherlands. Oumuamua, the asteroid that is believed to originate from outside of the solar system was observed by the GBT for 8 hours. The analysis was recently published in AAS Research Notes. The BL survey of the galactic centre would start soon with the Parkes telescope.

5. 11:10 – 11:20 - Upcoming Meetings, Publications

COSPAR – Mid July in California (Pasedena). AS is the main scientific organizer. Deadline is February 9 for SETI abstract submission.

Astrobiology in Australia on 25-26 June 2018 (IM)
CO is also organizing another meeting, in a couple of years, on
Bioastronomy (CM).

Bremen in October 2018 – only 20 slots for SETI papers in
Sessions 1 and 2. If there is overflow, presenters should consider
the interactive presentation options.

CM – SETI does not have a journal, is it possible?

**ACTION ITEM: CM will pursue the possibility of a SETI journal
for Bremen discussion.** JE will help with ideas around journal
organization.

6. 11:20 – 11:25 - Review of ongoing actions - CM/MAG

A review of the action items arising from the meeting was
summarized by MAG.

7. 11:25 – 11:30 - Any Other Business – NONE

8. Next scheduled meeting date & time
2018 April 19 – 1600 UTC.